

refrigeration. Not only will you save time by eating something quick on your way out for the day, but you'll also save money.

3. Never eat breakfast at a hotel!

Unless it is included with accommodation (and we'll get to that pitfall in a minute), hotels usually charge exorbitantly for breakfast, knowing that it is easiest for you to start your day with a meal right on your doorstep. If you insist on eating a full breakfast at a restaurant, then take the time to find an inexpensive diner where the locals eat. You'll likely pay half the price.

4. Buy prepared foods at a grocery store

Many grocery stores have sandwiches (some of which are made to order), soups, salads, hot meals, and even sushi. Pick something up to go, and have a picnic while you are out and about. Or if it's dinnertime, take your meal back to the room and serve up your inexpensive meal by candlelight. Create your own ambiance, and you won't have to worry about tipping the server or being pushed out the door if you want to linger over the meal.

5. Beware of snack foods and concession stands

It seems that hot chocolate, roasted peanuts, or ice cream stands are

strategically planted in front of every major tourist destination around the world. If you wouldn't get that snack or beverage at home, then don't do it on vacation. You'll probably pay too much for that ice cream cone anyway. If the kids won't let the ice cream idea go, then go to a local convenience or grocery store and buy a box of prepackaged ice cream cones or Popsicles and pay less than half as much money.



ACCOMMODATIONS

This is the number-one expense you will incur while on vacation (unless you are flying). The range of prices depend not only on the establishment and amenities, but also the location and time of year. Choose carefully.

6. Beware of the free breakfast

Although it may be enticing and convenient to have a free breakfast, you are paying for it one way or another. And if the breakfast turns out to be stale muffins, weak coffee, and some fruit, you may be losing money hand over fist. Even if the breakfast is glorious, compare how much you are paying for accommodations with breakfast versus without. Would you eat a full breakfast like that either